Teaching Statement

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I want students to learn how to use quantitative methods and how to question the results those methods give them. Many of the numbers we use in the social sciences depend on how variables are measured and on the assumptions behind the estimates. In my research I study how these choices change what we conclude about inequality and mobility. In class I try to make them visible.

At the LSE Summer School I am a class teacher for EC210 Inequality and Poverty Analysis, which means I teach seminars that accompany the lectures. I structure each seminar in three parts. We start with a recap of the main concepts from the lecture, so that students consolidate their understanding before they apply it. We then discuss the mandatory reading. In many seminars a group of students presents the paper first, and I set two or three questions to guide the discussion. We finish with exercises similar to those students will meet in the exam.

My teaching is hands-on. I use the whiteboard to illustrate ideas and derive results step by step, so that students can see where each assumption enters. In EC210 many results depend on choices of method. The choice of equivalence scale, or of measuring income before or after housing costs, changes who counts as poor. Converting incomes with purchasing power parities instead of market exchange rates changes how much global inequality we find.

Summer School students come from many ethnic backgrounds and academic disciplines, so I encourage them to work in teams. This helps them get to know each other early on and lets them draw on each other's training. For example, a student who is comfortable with the algebra and one who knows how household surveys work in practice may notice different problems with the same poverty estimate.

In 2025 I received the class teacher award for EC210. In that year's course evaluation, students rated my teaching 4.91 out of 5 (23 responses from 31 enrolled students), and all but one agreed that the seminars were well structured and organised. Asked what they liked best, one student wrote that the course "taught us tools to analyze poverty and inequality, then allowed us to actually use those tools".

For MY457 Causal Inference for Observational and Experimental Studies, a postgraduate course in the Department of Methodology, my role covered the problem sets and office hours. Office hours let me work through problems with students one to one and see where each student gets stuck.

My teaching also draws on my research. I teach quantitative tools and how to apply them to social science questions, with two ideas in mind. The first is choosing the right tool for the question. If the question is about the mean, we should use tools that describe the mean. If it is about the distribution, we need tools built for distributions. Much of my research falls in the second case, where I estimate whole distributions with quantile methods and transformation forests. Students need to be able to make this choice for their own questions. The second idea is reproducibility. I write research code that others can reuse, such as the R package tstsqa, which implements the quantile adjustment method from my job market paper. Reproducible work depends on others being able to check it, so the coding skill I most want students to develop is reading code and judging whether it does what it is meant to do, including code written by AI tools.

I can teach substantive courses on social policy, inequality and poverty. I can also teach a broad range of quantitative methods courses in the social sciences, including mathematics and statistics for social scientists, introductory econometrics, applied cross-sectional analysis and causal inference, machine learning and applied machine learning, and data and programming courses. I can teach in English, Spanish and German.